ASSOCIATION OF ENGLISH TEACHERS, Mangalore University

BCA SEMESTER IV- BCAENLS401- (SEP)

QUESTION BANK

KARUKKU- BY BAMA

I. Answer following in not more than **two pages each**: **10 Marks**

1. Discuss *Karukku* as a powerful portrayal of Dalit suppression.
2. Give a glimpse of Bama's village as described by her in the beginning of her story.
3. Comment on the deeply embedded caste system that permeates Bama's village.
4. Explain the significance of the title *Karukku*. How does it reflect Bama's journey?
5. Discuss Bama's experiences in school and college. How do these institutions reinforce caste identity?
6. In what ways does *Karukku* move from personal experience to collective social voice?
7. Do you think *Karukku* is a story of suffering or resistance? Justify your answer with examples.
8. Trace Bama's journey from innocence to awareness.
9. Discuss the importance of autobiographical narration in presenting an image of Dalit life as seen in *Karukku*
10. Narrate the story around Nallathanga temple.
11. Bring out the incidents of 'untouchability' as seen by Bama in her early childhood.
12. Recount the humiliation that Bama experienced at school in the 'coconut tree incident'.
13. Analyze the role of education in Bama's life.
14. Analyze the condition of women laborers and critically comment on the exploitation of Dalit labor by landowners and tradesmen.
15. How does Bama bring out the stark divide between the 'haves' and the' have-nots' in her village?
16. Comment on Bama's experience as a nun.
17. Evaluate the narrator's quest for dignity, identity, and freedom
18. In what ways can *Karukku* be considered a Dalit autobiography rather than a conventional autobiography?
19. "Dalit autobiography is a form of social protest." Discuss this statement with reference to *Karukku.*

20. “The convent was a world in itself”. Why does Bama say so?
21. Illustrate the Christmas and Easter celebrations in the village.
22. Comment on ‘the role and reality’ of the order Bama joined as a nun.
23. How is caste portrayed as an overpowering, all pervasive phenomenon in the novel?
24. Narrate the ways in which women of the Dalit community manage the troubled times without their men around.
25. “Dalit autobiography is essentially an autobiography of a community” How is this statement true of *Karukku*? Discuss.

Answer the following questions in **a page each**: **5 Marks**

1. Who is Bondan–Maama? What are the stories about him?
2. How does Bama describe the deeply embedded caste system in her village?
3. Comment on the incident of an elderly Parayar carrying snacks for a Naicker.
4. Is education considered as liberating in the story?
5. How was Bama treated at the B.Ed. College?
6. How does Bama foresee a changed and just society?
7. Describe the work and wages of Dalit children in Bama’s village.
8. Comment on the stagnation of the quality of Dalit life despite their hard work.
9. What are the different games that small children and older boys and girls played?
10. What games did the adults of the village play?
11. How did the family survive when Bama’s father was in the army?
12. How did life change for Bama after she did her B.Ed?
13. Why does Bama say “Convent life had changed me fundamentally”?
14. Give an account of the church-going days of Bama as a child.
15. Describe the visits of Bama and her schoolmates to Chinnamalai.
16. Give an account of the school Bama first worked at soon after finishing college.
17. How did the friends and family respond to Bama’s idea of becoming a nun?
18. What, according to Bama, is true religion and devotion?
19. Sketch the character of Uudan.
20. How humor and nicknames are used in depicting the village life?
21. Write a note on the influence of Bama’s brother in her life.

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